



Agric-Led Livelihood Project

Needs Assessment Report:

Kware & Wamakko LGAs, Sokoto State

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Executive Summary

This report presents findings from a comprehensive needs assessment conducted in Kware and Wamakko LGAs, Sokoto State. Agriculture remains the backbone of household livelihoods, yet productivity is constrained by limited access to inputs, irrigation, markets, and financial services. Women and youth face systemic barriers, while climate variability exacerbates risks.

The report recommends interventions in climate-smart agriculture, cooperative development, financial inclusion, and infrastructure improvement to strengthen resilience, food security, and income generation.

Background



Agriculture is the primary livelihood in Sokoto State, with millet, sorghum, maize, cowpea, and groundnut as staple crops. Livestock rearing (goats, sheep, poultry) complements crop production. Despite strong community reliance on agriculture, productivity is low due to traditional practices, poor infrastructure, and limited access to modern inputs.

Kware and Wamakko LGAs were selected for this assessment due to their high dependence on agriculture and vulnerability to climate shocks.



Methodology

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Tool Used



Respondents



Themes
Explored



Limitations



01 Tools Used

Household surveys, focus group discussions (FGDs), key informant interviews (KIIs)

01 Respondents

120 households (60 per LGA), community leaders, extension agents, market actors.

01 Respondents

Demographics, farming practices, income, market access, training needs, risks, aspirations.

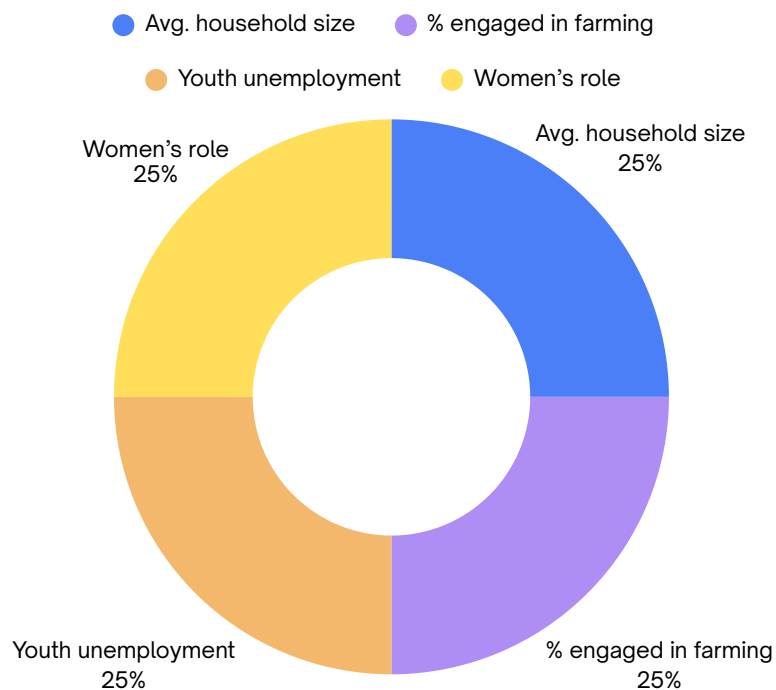
01 Limitations

Seasonal migration reduced youth participation; women's voices required targeted FGDs.

Findings

4.1 Demographics

Indicator	Kware	Wamakko
Avg. household size	8	9
% engaged in farming	82%	85%
Youth unemployment	High	High
Women's role	Processing, petty trade	Processing, petty trade



Findings

4.2 Farming Practices

- Crops: Millet, sorghum, maize, cowpea, groundnut.
- Livestock: Goats, sheep, poultry.
- Land: 1–3 hectares, mostly rain-fed.
- Inputs: Reliance on traditional tools; limited improved seeds/fertilizers.
- Water: Irrigation scarce; dependence on rainfall.

4.3 Income & Market Access

- 01 Agriculture contributes 70–80% of household income.
- 02 Produce sold mainly in local markets; middlemen dominate pricing.
- 03 Poor road networks and lack of storage facilities reduce profitability.
- 04 Women sell processed products but face scaling challenges.

Findings

4.4 Knowledge & Skills

- Weak extension services.
- Farmers request training in:
- Pest/disease management
- Soil fertility improvement
- Post-harvest handling
- Financial literacy



4.5 Challenges & Risks

- Climate Change: Erratic rainfall, prolonged dry spells, occasional flooding.
- Pests/Diseases: Striga weed, locusts, livestock diseases.
- Financial Access: Limited credit facilities; high interest rates discourage borrowing.
- Youth Migration: Seasonal migration reduces labor availability.
- Gender Barriers: Women lack access to land ownership and formal financing.

Aspirations



- Improved irrigation for year-round farming.
- Stronger cooperatives for market bargaining.
- Value addition (processing, packaging).
- Youth interest in vocational training linked to agribusiness.



Priority Needs

- Climate Change: Erratic rainfall, prolonged dry spells, occasional flooding.
- Pests/Diseases: Striga weed, locusts, livestock diseases.
- Financial Access: Limited credit facilities; high interest rates discourage borrowing.
- Youth Migration: Seasonal migration reduces labor availability.
- Gender Barriers: Women lack access to land ownership and formal financing.

Recommendations

- Establish farmer cooperatives for collective bargaining.
- Introduce climate-smart agriculture practices
- Strengthen extension services through partnerships.
- Develop value chain interventions (processing, branding).
- Facilitate microfinance tailored to smallholders and women.
- Invest in rural infrastructure (roads, storage, irrigation).
- Create youth-focused programs to reduce migration.

Conclusion

Kware and Wamakko LGAs face significant livelihood challenges but demonstrate strong resilience and willingness to adopt improved practices. Targeted interventions in inputs, training, infrastructure, and financial inclusion can transform agricultural livelihoods, enhance food security, and reduce poverty.



Annexes

Annex 1: Suggested Project Components

- Input Support: Seed distribution, fertilizer subsidies.
- Water Management: Community irrigation schemes.
- Market Development: Storage facilities, road rehabilitation.
- Capacity Building: Farmer field schools, women's training groups.
- Financial Services: Village savings and loan associations (VSLAs).
- Youth Engagement: Agribusiness hubs, vocational training.

Annex 2: Risk Mitigation Strategies

- Promote drought-resistant crop varieties.
- Establish community-based pest surveillance.
- Introduce crop/livestock insurance schemes.
- Strengthen early warning systems for climate shocks

Annex 3: Monitoring & Evaluation Framework

- Indicators: Crop yield, household income, market access, training participa

